Lesson 4 — One Small Thing, Many Times

Part 1 of 12: Passage — One Small Thing, Many Times

Level: A2+ (fourth step)

About 20 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

> How to do the listening. The same rule as every lesson so far: the student listens twice with no text, then reads. Audio files: `01-passage.mp3` first, then the other parts in order. Part `05-have-has-forms.mp3` is new — the short forms of have and has.

1.1 Before listening (2 minutes, Arabic is fine here)

1. What have you learned without a teacher?
2. How long have you studied English?
3. Is there something you started and have not finished yet?

1.4 Now read the passage

Passage: One Small Thing, Many Times (400 words)

Lina is twenty-four. She lives in Gaza, and she has studied information technology at her college for three years. She has also done something her teachers never asked for: she has taught herself web design.

[A] It started two years ago, with a free course on the internet. The course has more than forty lessons, and Lina has finished thirty-eight of them. She has never met her teacher. He lives in another country, and she has only seen his hands, moving on a keyboard, in short videos.

The connection in her building is slow, so she has learned to work in a careful way. She downloads a lesson at night, when the internet is quieter. She watches it in the morning, with no connection at all. She has lost her work many times, and now she saves every few minutes.

[B] Her uncle has a small shop near the market. He has sold the same things for twenty years — bags, shoes, school things — and he has always sold them in the same way. People come to the shop, or they telephone him.

In March, Lina built a website for the shop. It is a simple one: four pages, some photographs, the prices, and a button that opens a message to her uncle's phone. She published it on a free service, because the shop has no money for anything else. It took her eleven days.

[C] Since March, the shop has had customers from three other cities. They have never seen the shop, and they will probably never see it. They found the website, they looked at the prices, and they sent a message. Two of them have ordered from the shop more than once.

Her uncle has not learned to use a computer, and he does not want to. He has never used email. But he has asked Lina for two new pages, and he has started to say "my website" when he talks to his friends.

[D] Lina has not finished the course yet. Two lessons are left, and they are the hardest ones. She has already decided what she will build after them: an account system, so that a customer can see what he has ordered before.

She says the same thing to every student who asks her how to begin. "I have not done anything big," she says. "I have done one small thing, many times, for two years".

1.5 Read aloud

Read the passage aloud once and record it. Compare it with your Lesson 3 recording: is the voice steadier now?